Romina Ramos

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EDUCATION

University of the Virgin Islands St. Thomas, USVI
Master of Marine and Environmental Studies Expected: 2027
Advisor: Dr. Marianne Moore
Thesis: Assessing coastal light pollution at green (*Chelonia mydas*) and hawksbill (*Eretmochelys imbricata*) sea turtle habitats in St. Croix, U.S. Virgin Islands

Green Mountain College Poultney, VT
Bachelor of Science in Environmental Studies 2008-2012

Study Abroad
Korean Studies Summer Program
Daejeon University, South Korea 2011

CERTIFICATIONS

- Boating Safety Education (2017) State of Rhode Island DEM
- Emergency First Responder (CPR, AED, First Aid)
- Motorboat Operators Certification Course (MOCC)
- SCUBA Open Water, Advanced Adventure and Rescue Diver
- Captive Bolt User Certification
- AAUS Scientific Diver

PRESENTATIONS

Volunteers for Sea Turtle Monitoring in St. Croix, USVI Charleston, SC
International Sea Turtle Symposium 2019
Poster presentation on expanding community-based sea turtle monitoring efforts in St. Croix.

EXPERIENCE

US Virgin Islands Division of Fish and Wildlife *June 2025 – Present*
Wildlife Biologist I

- Responds and documents wildlife incidents and strandings
- Provides mentorship and supervision to high school and undergraduate students on the natural resources, including coral reefs, mangroves, wetlands, tropical dry forests and invasive species
- Collaborates with nonprofits, institutions, and territorial agencies on wildlife surveys for sea turtles, the Virgin Islands tree boa, lizards and native and migratory birds
- Supports the Division by preparing, organizing, and inspecting equipment for habitat restoration projects, wildlife surveys, and community outreach events

The Ocean Foundation *April 2025 – August 2025*
Marine Turtle Technician

- Facilitated turtle watch programs for school and community groups at Sandy Point NWR
- Monitored nesting activities for leatherback, green, and hawksbill sea turtles
- Conducted extensive habitat restoration including the removal of invasive plants

The Ocean Foundation *August 2024 – December 2024*
Marine Turtle Technician

- Directed night and morning patrols at Buck Island Reef National Monument
- Tagged and collected biometric data from hawksbill and green sea turtles
- Relocated nests threatened by inundation and performed excavations
- Organized project equipment, recorded inventory, and accurately entered data
- Supervised the collection of field research to ensure data integrity and consistency

American Conservation Experience *June 2024 – July 2024*
Youth Conservation Corps Leader
- Assisted refuge staff with planning and development of YCC activities for interns
- Guided and managed interns in general maintenance, trail maintenance, sea turtle patrols and excavations, tree planting, and invasive species removal at Sandy Point NWR
- Modeled and adhered to safety protocols to ensure the safety of the group
- Collected and submitted YCC members' time sheets, evaluations, and disciplinary forms

The St. Croix Environmental Association *March 2018 – October 2019*
Snorkel Clinic Coordinator
- Coordinated and advertised public snorkel clinics on coastal beaches
- Educated children and adults on the proper use of snorkel gear, snorkel safety in their marine environment, and ID marine life
- Sanitized and prepared snorkel gear, maintained inventory and processed donations
- Exceptional communication and collaboration with the executive director, seasonal snorkel guides and volunteers

The St. Croix Environmental Association *March 2018 – August 2019*
Office Manager and Outreach Assistant
- Provided welcoming and responsive front reception services and managed office
- Designed and distributed brochures, flyers, and newsletters
- Published events and announcements on social media
- Surveyed marine turtles and terrestrial wildlife at Southgate Coastal Reserve
- Demonstrated outreach services by distributing native trees to the community
- Organized public snorkel clinics on coastal beaches and wildlife events
- Quickly responded to disoriented marine turtles and strandings
- Coordinated events, programs, outreach and operated SEA's shop
- Collaborated with wildlife agencies and organizations on wildlife monitoring
- Coordinated the Coral Conservation Corps at the Buccaneer Resort for teens and led marine lectures, labs, group exercises, field trips, and an advocacy project

Student Conservation Association *March 2016 – August 2016*
Leatherback Research Assistant
- Conducted afternoon and evening patrols, recorded activities, and photographed injuries
- Tagged Inconel and PIT on nesting females and collected biometric data
- Collected skin biopsies from nesting females and hatchlings
- Relocated nests threatened by inundation and performed excavations

Maio Biodiversity Foundation *July 2015 – November 2015*
Loggerhead Team Leader
- Organized nocturnal patrols and morning census in the village of Morro
- Provided training exercises for guards, locals, and international volunteers
- Collected biometric data and skin biopsies for Queen Mary College
- Monitored nests, performed excavations, and assisted in a hatchery study
- Traveled to other coastal villages for sea turtle monitoring and training

- Successfully converted neighboring artificial lights on the beach to red lights
- Photographed areas of Morro's beach threatened by sand mining
- Implemented awareness, educational events, and weekly potlucks in Morro
- Awarded the Most Active Zone Award after contending with 13 sea turtle villages in Maio

Geographic Consulting *April 2015 – July 2015*
Sea Turtle Technician
- Conducted daytime and nighttime patrols at Sandy Point National Wildlife Refuge
- Tagged endangered leatherbacks, collected measurements, biopsies & photographed injuries
- Identified and relocated nests threatened by erosion and performed nest excavations

Biomes Marine Biology Center *October 2014 – March 2015*
Aquarist and Educator
- Demonstrated exceptional knowledge educating visitors, teachers, students and families on marine animals at touch tanks
- Participated in weekly biomes events and overnight educational programs
- Prepared diets for marine animals, sanitized habitat tanks, and properly monitored water quality

Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) *November 2012 – June 2013*
School Age Childcare Coordinator
- Developed engaging indoor and outdoor curriculum applicable for school aged children
- Supervised four staff members and 60 children
- Provided safe transportation of school children and conducted homework assistance
- Opened and closed site off from the main building and collected weekly payments
- Demonstrated clear and concise frequent communication with parents regarding their child's absence, behavior and progress

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service at Sandy Point National Wildlife Refuge
Volunteer Technician December 2015 – Present
- Assist biologists with natural resource projects, wildlife monitoring, and sea turtle rescue
- Plant native species, clear and trim trails and perform general maintenance
- Conduct lizard surveys at Green Cay National Wildlife Refuge
- Organize mist netting for bird banding and collect data on migratory birds
- Patrol and record leatherback, hawksbill, and green sea turtle activities
- Exhume nests, volunteer on public sea turtle walks, sea turtle outreach, and beach cleanups
- Assist with in-water SCUBA surveys of juvenile and adult hawksbills; measure, weigh, tag (PIT and flipper), record data and release turtles
- Participate in training workshops to obtain best wildlife management practices

South Carolina Aquarium *September 2013 – December 2013*
Sea Turtle Rescue Intern
- Prepared diets for sea turtles, cleaned tanks and filtration systems daily
- Assisted in medical treatments and diagnosis of injured turtles
- Responsible for environmental enrichment and hospital maintenance
- Led hospital tours and assisted in sea turtle release on public beaches

Turtle Foundation - Research Assistant *Cabo Verde Seasonal 2012*
Project Biodiversity - Wildlife Ranger *Cabo Verde Seasonal 2011*
- Executed diurnal and nocturnal patrols

- Tagged and monitored nesting females
- Collected morphological data and measured light intensity on adults and hatchlings
- Relocated nests threatened by artificial lights, inundations, and poachers
- Built and monitored hatcheries, performed excavations and released hatchlings
- Participated in beach cleanups, community outreach, and sea turtle festivals
- Maintained project equipment and tools at campsites
- Consistent availability in excess of 60 hours a week

LANGUAGES

- Fluent in Cape Verdean Creole
- Conversational in Portuguese and Spanish